

PRESS KIT

C.H.A.I.S.E.S.

The Social Geometry of the Luxembourg Gardens

20 – 22 October 2026

Opening Tuesday 20 October, 5 – 8pm

24 rue Chapon, 75003 Paris

Le Marais • Free entry



Sculpture • Painting • Drawing • Sound • Installation

Six artists

Jimmy Gardner • Allard van Hoorn • Quinn Lewis

Wayne Pate • Jessica Anne Schwartz • Charlotte Tapol

A project by Jimmy Gardner • Creative direction Allard van Hoorn

Produced by the New to the Wall Foundation
lachaiseparisienne.com • [@new.to.the.wall.art](https://www.instagram.com/new.to.the.wall.art)

Every morning the chairs go back to the grid. Every evening, Paris redraws them.

What	C.H.A.I.S.E.S. — The Social Geometry of the Luxembourg Gardens. A three-day exhibition: sculpture, painting, drawing, sound, installation.
When	20 – 22 October 2026 · Opening Tuesday 20 October, 5 – 8pm · Wednesday and Thursday, noon – 8pm
Where	24 rue Chapon, 75003 Paris (Le Marais) · Métro Arts et Métiers / Rambuteau · Free entry
Who	Six artists: Jimmy Gardner, Allard van Hoorn, Quinn Lewis, Wayne Pate, Jessica Anne Schwartz, Charlotte Tapol
By	The New to the Wall Foundation (New York / Paris) — its first Paris exhibition

Every morning a gardener in the Jardin du Luxembourg resets the green metal chairs into a neutral grid. Over the day, Paris redraws them: two chairs that draw close and then drift apart, a single chair tracking the sun, a reader keeping an arm's length of distance. Nobody directs this choreography. Almost nobody sees it.

For a year, collector and entrepreneur Jimmy Gardner watched these formations. Four of them kept returning: the sun-worshipper, the lovers' spat, the reader, the gathering. They became the four scenarios of C.H.A.I.S.E.S., a three-day exhibition in the Marais in which six artists translate them into sculpture, painting, drawing, sound and installation.

"I noticed the chairs grouped in these little settings, and it hit me that they were a reflection of our society, of our humanity. How did they get like that? Then I started thinking about the chairs as data — vectors, trajectories. Everything followed from there."

Jimmy Gardner, originator of the project and co-founder of the New to the Wall Foundation

The project is directed by Dutch, Paris-based artist and composer Allard van Hoorn, whose *Urban Songlines* have been shown at Tate St Ives, the Whitney Museum and the Van Abbemuseum. Jimmy Gardner shows four sculptures, one per scenario. Charlotte Tapol paints the diptych *Reliquary of Touch*; Wayne Pate, who drew the emblem, shows three *rendez-vous avec une chaise*; Jessica Anne Schwartz shows twelve synaesthesia drawings of the garden's soundscape; Quinn Lewis, life drawings and three *Kinetic Scrolls* that visitors wind by hand. Van Hoorn creates the sound performance — a Sénat chair on loan from the Luxembourg Gardens, played as an instrument — and the installation that holds it all together.

The chairs escape. From 6 October, miniature Luxembourg chairs are left around Paris — on ledges, on café tables, in the garden where they were born. Each carries a QR code under its seat: whoever finds one keeps it and reports where it now lives. #youfoundachaise

The exhibition opens on the eve of Art Basel Paris's VIP days (Grand Palais, 21 – 25 October) and on the opening day of Paris Internationale.

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Images HD images free for press use on request · Preview visits by appointment, 19 and 20 October afternoons · Interviews on request

Online lachaiseparisienne.com · Instagram @new.to.the.wall.art · #parischaise



Readers by the Grand Bassin, Jardin du Luxembourg, 2026. © New to the Wall Foundation

One observation, six artists

The observation

The chairs of the Jardin du Luxembourg are free. People move them, turn them, pull them together or apart, and every day the garden becomes a map of the connections between the people in it: conversations, arguments, solitudes, reunions. The next morning the grid erases everything and the day begins again.

For a year, Jimmy Gardner watched these formations. Four of them kept returning; they became the project's four scenarios.

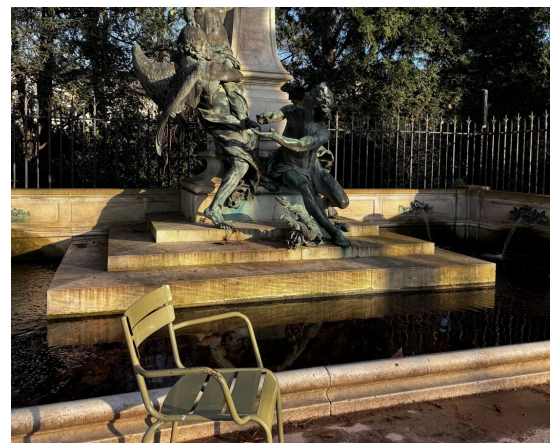
The translation

Rather than tracking real chairs individually by GPS, C.H.A.I.S.E.S. works from the higher level of abstraction of the four human scenarios. Those scenarios and their artifacts — movement, sound and emotion — inspire and inform the work: the same afternoon becomes a sculpture, a painting, a drawing, an instrumental voice.

The project draws on the analytical framework of William Forsythe's *One Flat Thing, reproduced* and Ohio State University's *Synchronous Objects*, which decomposed a single dance into dozens of visual, spatial and data-driven readings — extended here from the stage to the public garden, from professional dancers to the everyday choreography of social life.



Two chairs face to face, Jardin du Luxembourg, 2026. © New to the Wall Foundation



A chair at the fountain, Jardin du Luxembourg, 2026. © New to the Wall Foundation

The four scenarios



01 • Sun-Worshipping

A solitary figure tracks the light, making slow angular adjustments as the sun crosses the garden.



02 • Lover's Spat

Two chairs begin entwined, drift apart through tension, orbit in conflict, and either reconcile or leave.



03 • The Reader

Deliberate isolation. The chair positions itself away from traffic, creates a buffer zone, and barely moves all afternoon.



04 • The Gathering

Strands that never touch and never separate — a group holding an uncanny synchrony across the day: exchange, learning, the dynamics of a crowd.

Jimmy Gardner, *Sun-Worshippers*, *Lover's Spat*, *The Reader*, *The Gathering*, 2026, renderings of the bronze edition. © NTTW Foundation

Six artists, five forms

Jimmy Gardner — originator • sculpture

Collector, entrepreneur and co-founder of the New to the Wall Foundation, dividing his time between the Hudson Valley and Paris; his year of watching the chairs is where the project began. Four sculptures, one per scenario — *Sun-Worshippers*, *The Reader*, *Lover's Spat*, *The Gathering*: each vertical strand is one chair's afternoon, the octagonal plinth the garden itself. c. 33 cm; PLA, 5 + 1 AP, and lost-wax bronze to order.

Allard van Hoorn — creative director • sound, installation

Dutch artist and composer based in Paris; his *Urban Songlines* have been shown at Tate St Ives, the Whitney Museum, MAAT Lisbon and the Van Abbemuseum. For C.H.A.I.S.E.S., a sound performance: a Sénat chair on loan from the Luxembourg Gardens is played as an instrument — earth magnets and a resonator — *FERROUS*, by Landscape — release its collective memory as a score, built into an ambient composition; the walls carry a manifesto, an ode to chairs and their collective slowness. allardvanhoorn.com

Quinn Lewis — kinetic sculpture, drawing

Brooklyn-based multidisciplinary artist and Bard College graduate who combines sculpture and animation in layered, kinetic apparatuses. His life drawings *Chairs Under Sun* and *Chairs Under Shade* catch the chairs visitors leave behind, fixed by their shadows; his three *Kinetic Scrolls* let the viewer wind drawn garden visitors over a painted scene of chairs, composing their own uses of the garden.

Charlotte Tampol — painting

Brooklyn-based multidisciplinary artist (painting, printmaking, photography, tattoo). *Reliquary of Touch (Moment One / Moment Two)*, a diptych in acrylic and oil on canvas: a couple kisses, their chairs face to face; then the couple is gone, and the chairs remain in embrace, a purse left on one seat. @charlottetampolart

Jessica Anne Schwartz — drawing, synaesthesia

New York and Paris-based artist working for more than three decades. In 2023 she made the Luxembourg's chairs a fixed listening post: her *Jardin du Luxembourg Synaesthesia Drawings* transcribe the garden's soundscape — Sénat chairs, children, gravel, birdsong, wind, rain — in sumi ink, walnut ink, mica and gouache on Murillo paper. Twelve drawings on view. jessicaanneschwartz.com

Wayne Pate — painting, emblem

Self-taught Brooklyn painter, working since 1992; represented by Armature Projects, The Finch Project and Turrette. Creator of the emblem. Three *rendez-vous avec une chaise*, acrylic scratching on brown laid paper — “the brief morphing of the individual and the object”, in the Parisian idiom of posted bills. waynepate.com



Jimmy Gardner, the four sculptures, 2026, renderings of the bronze edition (lost-wax, 5 + 1 AP), c. 33 cm. © NTTW Foundation



Charlotte Tampol, *Reliquary of Touch (Moment One / Moment Two)*, 2026. © the artist



Quinn Lewis with a *Kinetic Scroll*, studio, Brooklyn, 2026. Photo courtesy the artist

New to the Wall Foundation

Founded by Jimmy Gardner and Shana Glickfield, based in New York's Hudson Valley and working between New York and Paris. Artists keep 100% of the proceeds of anything they sell; all revenue from Jimmy Gardner's sculptures is fed back into supporting emerging artists.

Three days in the Marais

Tuesday 20 October	Opening, 5–8pm
Wednesday 21 October	Open to the public, noon–8pm
Thursday 22 October	Open to the public, noon–8pm · closing evening 5–8pm
Venue	New to the Wall Foundation — project space 24 rue Chapon, 75003 Paris
Getting there	Métro Arts et Métiers (3, 11), Rambuteau (11) · Bus 20, 38, 47
Admission	Free, no booking required
Press	Preview visits by appointment on Monday 19 and Tuesday 20 October, afternoons · Interviews with Jimmy Gardner and Allard van Hoorn on request
Online	lachaiseparisienne.com · Instagram @new.to.the.wall.art · #parischaise #youfoundachaise

Press contact

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The chairs escape

From 6 October, miniature Luxembourg chairs — rebuilt from the original, tube by tube — leave the studio and are left around Paris. Each carries a QR code in a pocket under the seat. Whoever finds one keeps it, scans the code, says where it was sitting and shows where it lives now; every find puts a pin on the map at lachaiseparisienne.com. The hunt continues through the exhibition. #youfoundachaise



The Sénat chair for Allard van Hoorn's sound performance, Jardin du Luxembourg, 2026 — chaise prêtée par le jardin du Luxembourg-Sénat. © Allard van Hoorn



Jessica Anne Schwartz, *Jardin du Luxembourg Synaesthesia Drawings #6*, 2023, sumi ink, walnut ink, mica and hand-mixed gouache on heirloom Murillo paper, 49.5 × 35.6 cm. © Jessica Anne Schwartz



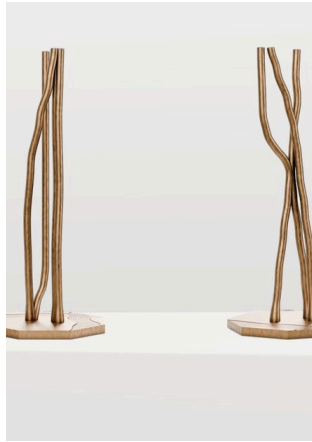
Quinn Lewis, *Chairs Under Sun No. 1*, 2026, ink and coloured pencil on kraft paper, 14.8 × 21 cm. © the artist

Available images

Free for press use in connection with the exhibition, with credit. HD files: jimmy@newtothewall.com. Also available: the four bronze renderings individually, all three of Wayne Pate's *rendez-vous*, further drawings by Quinn Lewis and Jessica Anne Schwartz.



1 · Wayne Pate, C.H.A.I.S.E.S. emblem, 2026, white line on black, kraft paper (scan). © Wayne Pate



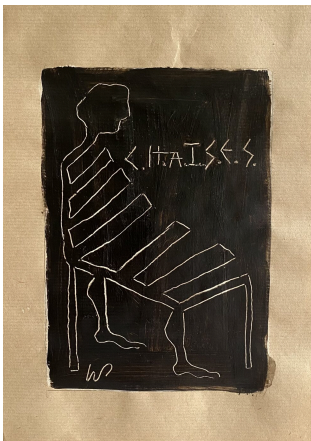
2 · Jimmy Gardner, the four sculptures, 2026, renderings of the bronze edition (lost-wax, 5 + 1 AP), c. 33 cm. © NTTW Foundation



3 · Charlotte Tapol, *Reliquary of Touch (Moment One)*, 2026, acrylic and oil on canvas, 61 x 91.5 cm. © the artist



4 · Charlotte Tapol, *Reliquary of Touch (Moment Two)*, 2026, acrylic and oil on canvas, 61 x 91.5 cm. © the artist



5 · Wayne Pate, *rendez-vous avec une chaise no. 1*, 2026, acrylic scratching on brown laid paper, 21 x 29.5 cm. © Wayne Pate



6 · Wayne Pate, *rendez-vous avec une chaise no. 2*, 2026, acrylic scratching on brown laid paper, 21 x 29.5 cm. © Wayne Pate



7 · Quinn Lewis, *Chairs Under Sun No. 1*, 2026, ink and coloured pencil on kraft paper, 14.8 x 21 cm. © the artist



8 · Quinn Lewis with a *Kinetic Scroll*, studio, Brooklyn, 2026. Photo courtesy the artist



9 · Jessica Anne Schwartz, *Jardin du Luxembourg Synaesthesia Drawings #6*, 2023, sumi ink, walnut ink, mica and hand-mixed gouache on heirloom Murillo paper, 49.5 x 35.6 cm. © Jessica Anne Schwartz



10 · Jessica Anne Schwartz, *Jardin du Luxembourg Synaesthesia Drawings #4*, 2023, sumi ink, walnut ink, mica and hand-mixed gouache on heirloom Murillo paper, 49.5 x 35.6 cm. © Jessica Anne Schwartz



11 · FERROUS, spinning magnetic polyphonic string resonator by Landscape — the sonic activator for the Sénat chair in Allard van Hoorn's sound performance, 2026. © Allard van Hoorn



12 · The Sénat chair for Allard van Hoorn's sound performance, Jardin du Luxembourg, 2026 — chaise prêtée par le jardin du Luxembourg-Sénat. © Allard van Hoorn